



Enterprise Alignment Through EA

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EAdirections - Managing Director

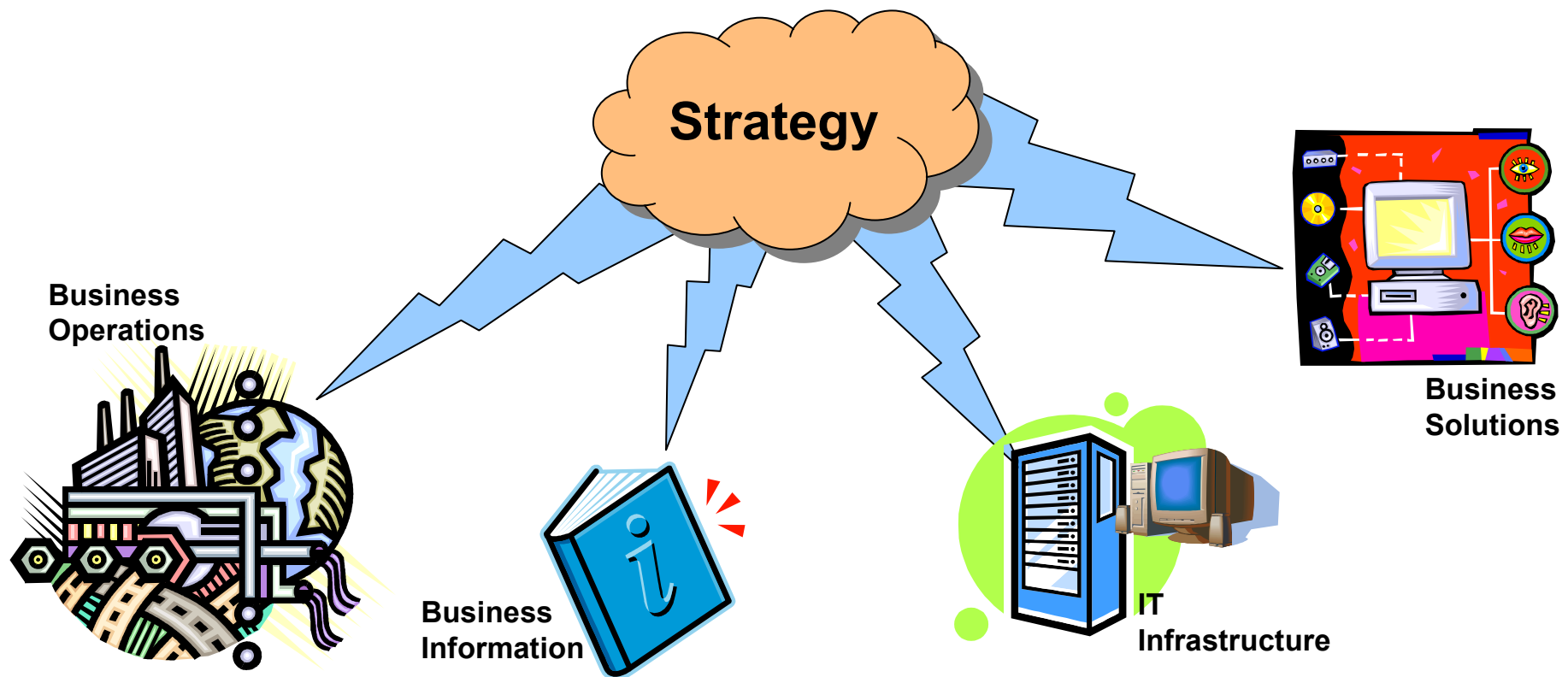
Presented at Enterprise Architecture Symposium

Toronto - March 30, 2009

- **The EA discipline continues to evolve as more and more executives, practitioners and business-side leaders begin to appreciate its strengths.**
 - More attention, visibility and executive emphasis
 - Higher or new expectations
 - Less tolerance for ivory-tower, theoretical perspectives and perfectionism
 - More focus on leadership, professionalism and results
 - CURRENT ECONOMY driving many to a more thoughtful, holistic approach to the future
- **Uniting Business and Information Technology requires addressing perceptions between the business and IT communities**
- **Our On-Going Challenge as Enterprise Architects is to demonstrate leadership in helping to address “Alignment” concerns**

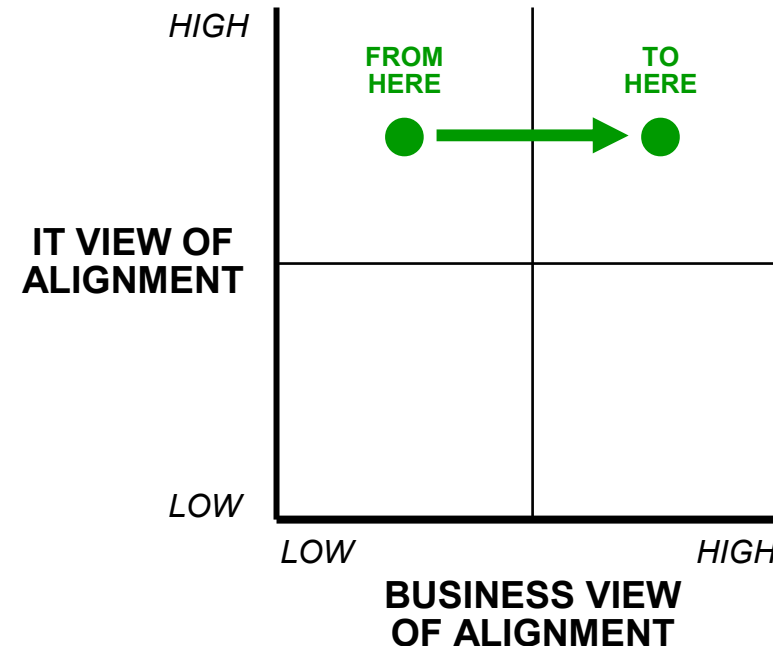
How to Get There? - The Problem

- How can an enterprise establish a reasonable idea for all that has to happen in a complex organization to accommodate necessary change in support of business transformation?



That “Alignment” Thing

- **Business/IT Alignment is a recurring issue**
 - Business transformation
 - Business growth
 - Competitive changes
 - Economic conditions
 - Leadership changes
 - Etc.
- **The degree of alignment is often determined by perception**
- **Very common that IT Leadership views ‘business and IT’ as more aligned than Business Leadership**
- **Often IT is correct but can’t demonstrate alignment in a way that is meaningful to the business**



“What Is It You Are Trying To Align?”

Business

Does 'Business' mean...

Business Objectives?

Business Strategies?

Business Processes?

Business Value?

....?

IT

Does 'IT' mean...

IT Projects?

Application Portfolio?

Technical Infrastructure?

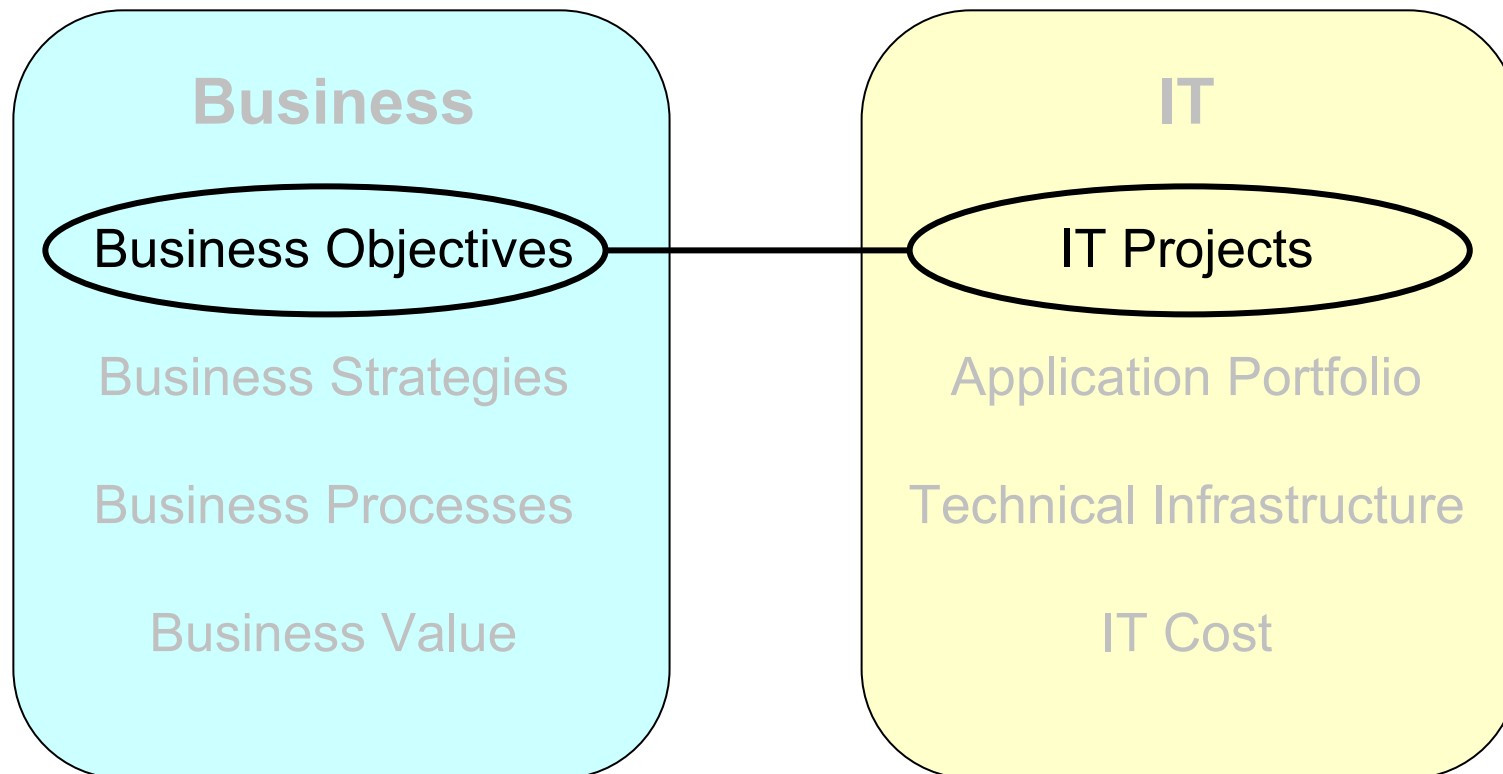
IT Cost?

....?

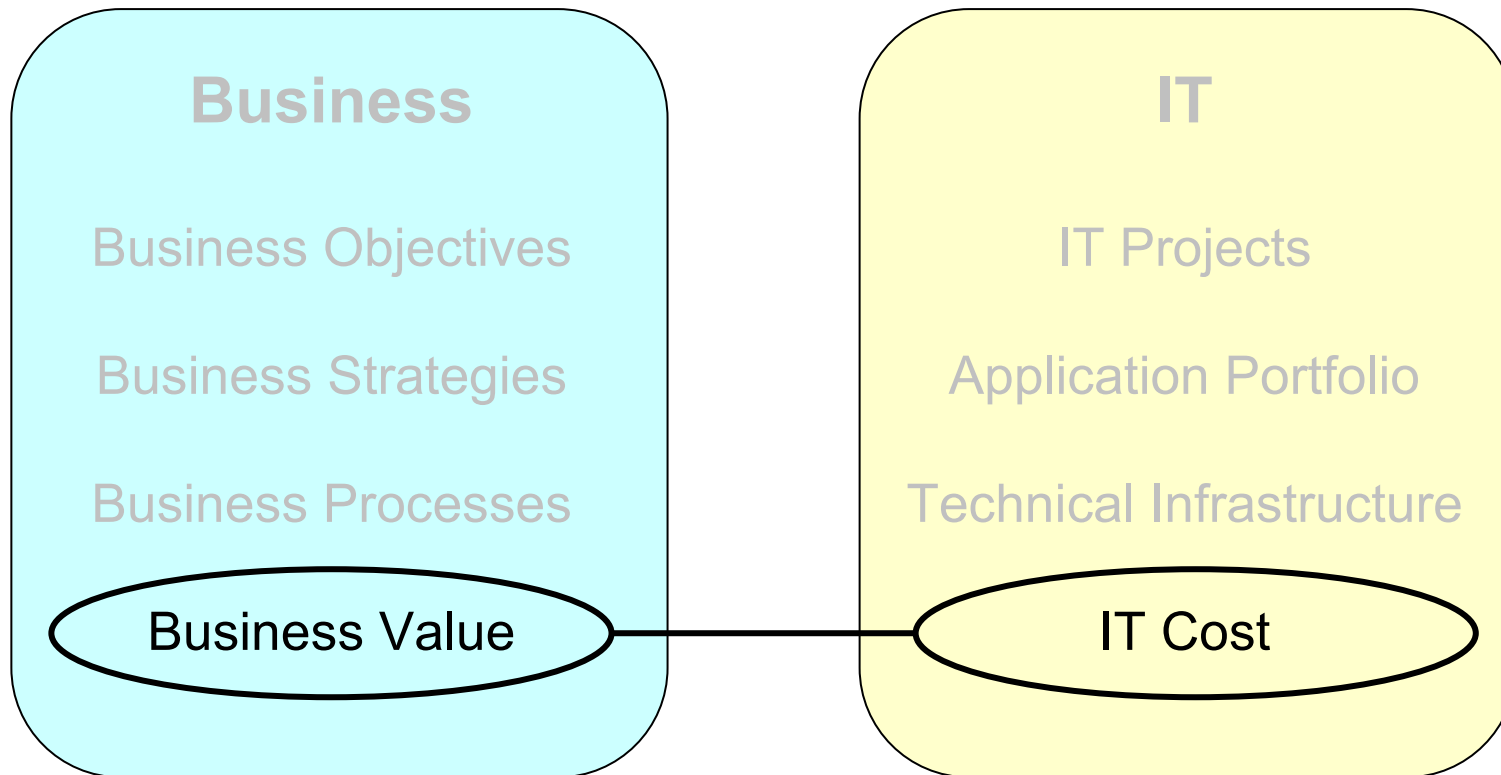
The challenge is Enterprise Ambiguity

The words 'Business' and 'IT' mean different things to different people

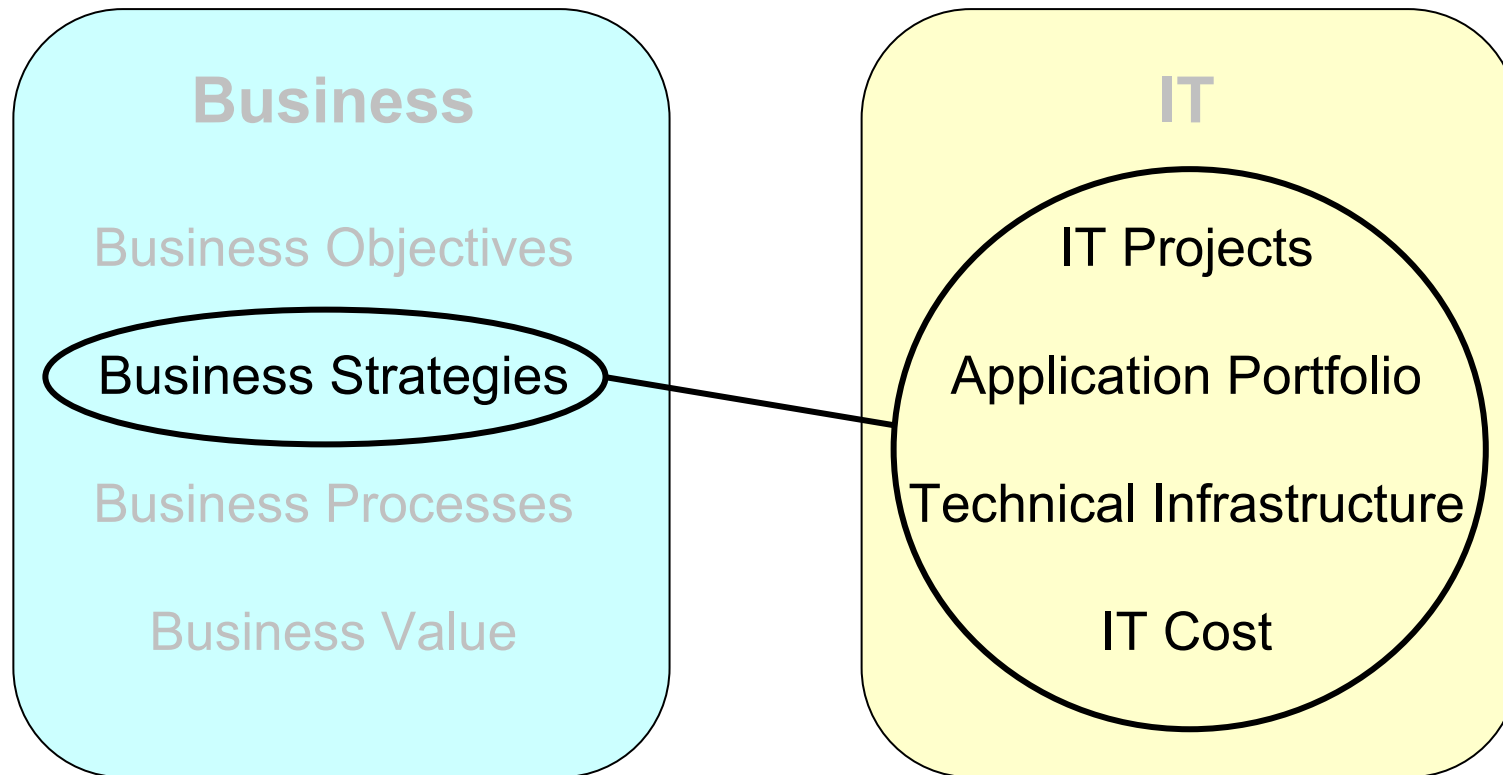
When BU leadership, COOs and many CIOs say
“Business/IT Alignment” they usually focus on...



When CFOs say “Business/IT Alignment” they usually focus on...



**When CEOs and the Board say “Business/IT Alignment”
they usually focus on...**



“What Is It You Are Trying To Align”?

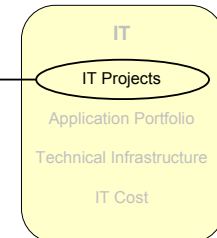
- “Business/IT Alignment” has many possible interpretations & expectations
- Different audiences have different interpretations
- There are many possible combinations assuming only 4 definitions for ‘Business’ and 4 definitions for ‘IT’

ACTION ITEMS

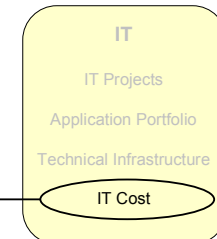
- Identify the different definitions and expectations for ‘Business/IT Alignment’ within your organization
- Make sure you account for the breadth of definitions and expectations in your efforts

RANGE OF EXPECTATIONS

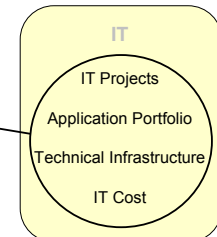
BUs
COOs
CIOs



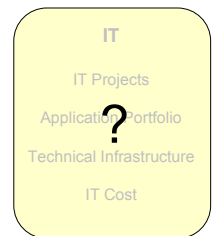
CFOs



CEOs
Boards



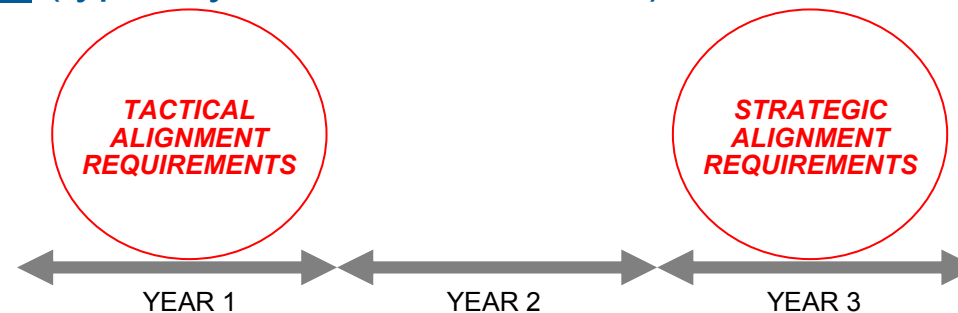
?



“What Is The Alignment Horizon?”

Alignment Horizon

- The **Alignment Horizon** refers to the period of time in which the specific Audience (or Audience member) wants to see “**Business/IT Alignment Achieved**”
- Some Audience members may be concerned with tactical alignment (typically 12 months or less)
- Some Audience members may be concerned with strategic alignment (typically 24 months or more)

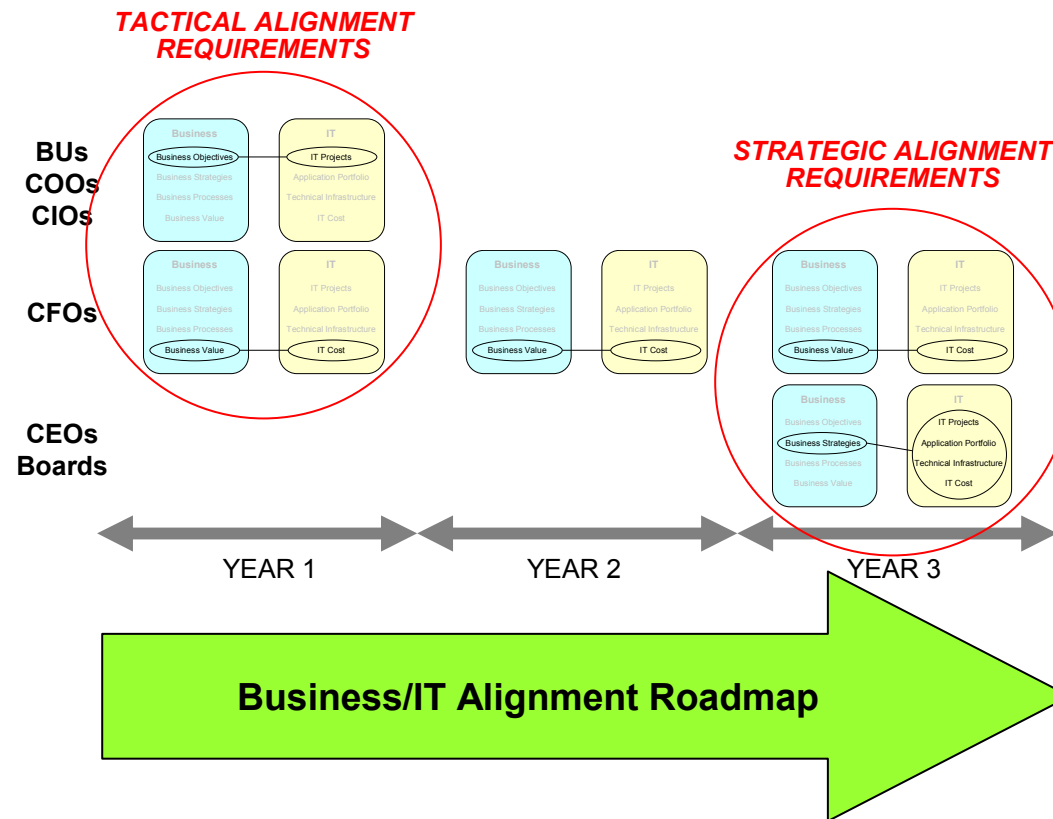


Challenges

- A common mistake we see is that artifacts attempting to demonstrate “**Business/IT Alignment**” focus on a single point in time (or ignore ‘time’ as a key descriptor)
- Each Audience may have a different timeframe in mind
- Each Audience may have multiple timeframes in mind

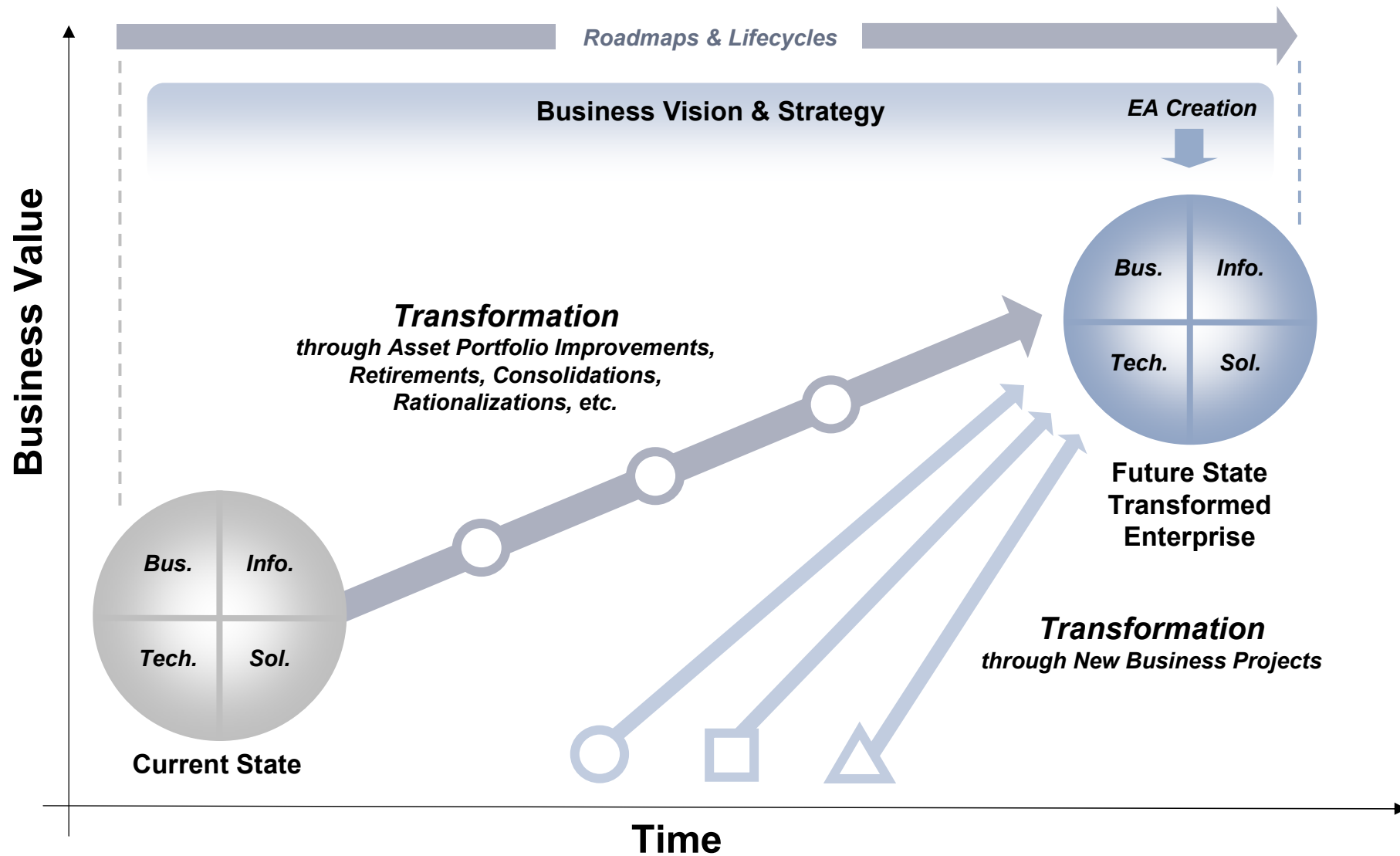
Multiple Audiences – Multiple Horizons

This is only an example. Not meant to imply that all CIOs only focus on tactics or that all CEOs only focus on strategy. Etc. Etc.

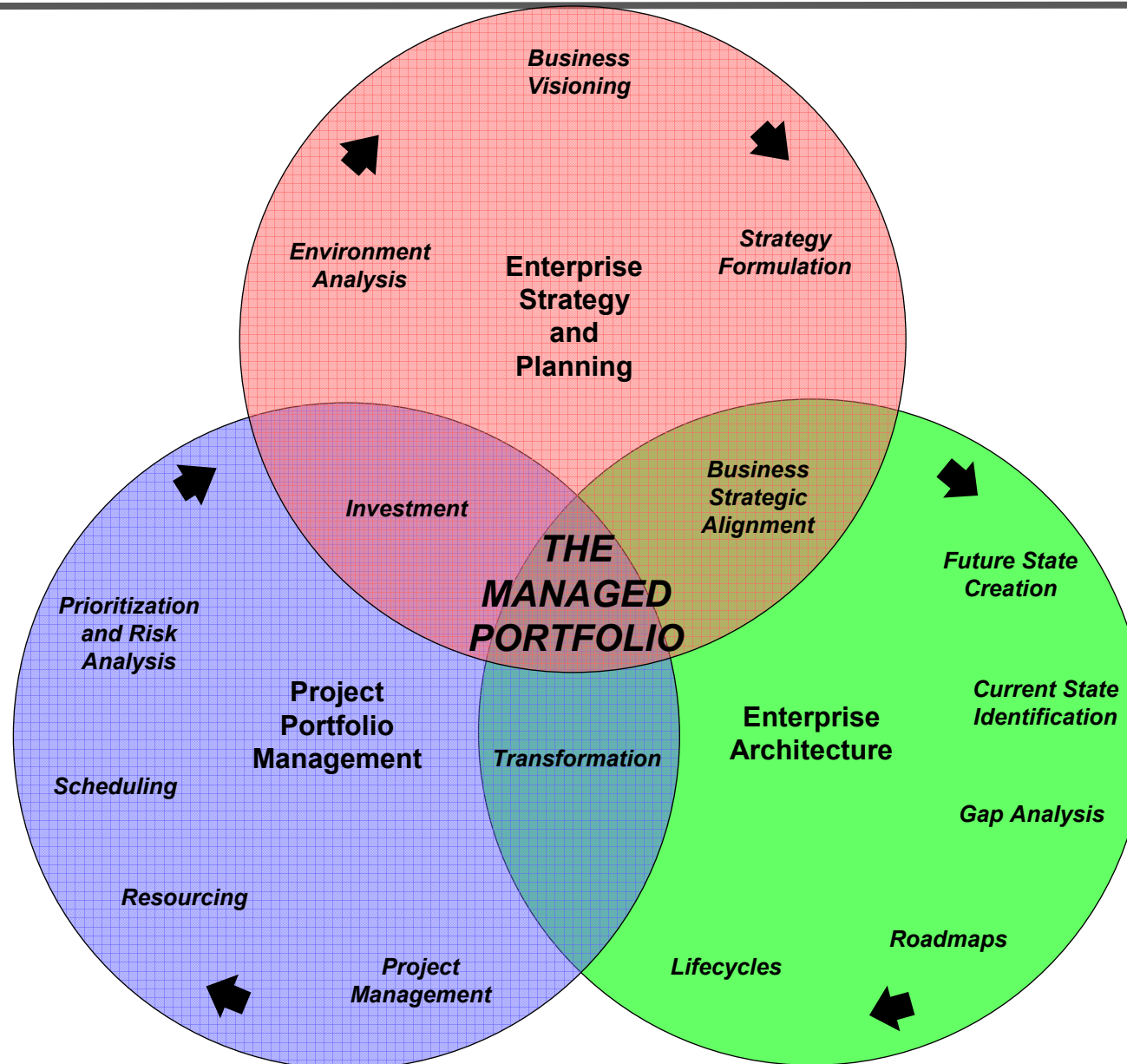


In addition to understanding and accounting for multiple Audiences and multiple Alignment Horizons, we also need to prepare a credible Business/IT Alignment Roadmap

Driving Business Transformation



The Portfolio Processes



Holistic Optimization (Portfolio)

- “To what extent is the organization holistically optimized?”
- “What are the CEO & Leadership Team’s attitude toward holistic optimization?”

IT Effectiveness

- “How does the CEO & Leadership Team evaluate IT’s current effectiveness?”
- “How effective does the CEO & Leadership Team believe IT needs to be for the organization to achieve its strategic objectives?”

To Align, Create an EA that ...

- Expresses the impact of Business Strategy on the operations of your business, the information you need, the applications that support your business, and the infrastructure upon which they are built
- Establishes a set of principles that drives consistent decision making across disparate groups of decision makers
- Establishes/Publishes/Evolves a set of standards and guidelines from which projects and other implementation activities take direction
- Creates models that provide a broad context for impact analysis, scenario planning, reuse opportunity identification
- Compares the future state against the current state and develops a Roadmap that shows how to migrate from As-Is to To-Be
- Creates an environment of collaboration and consensus-building between management, architects, SMEs, analysts, developers and business sponsors

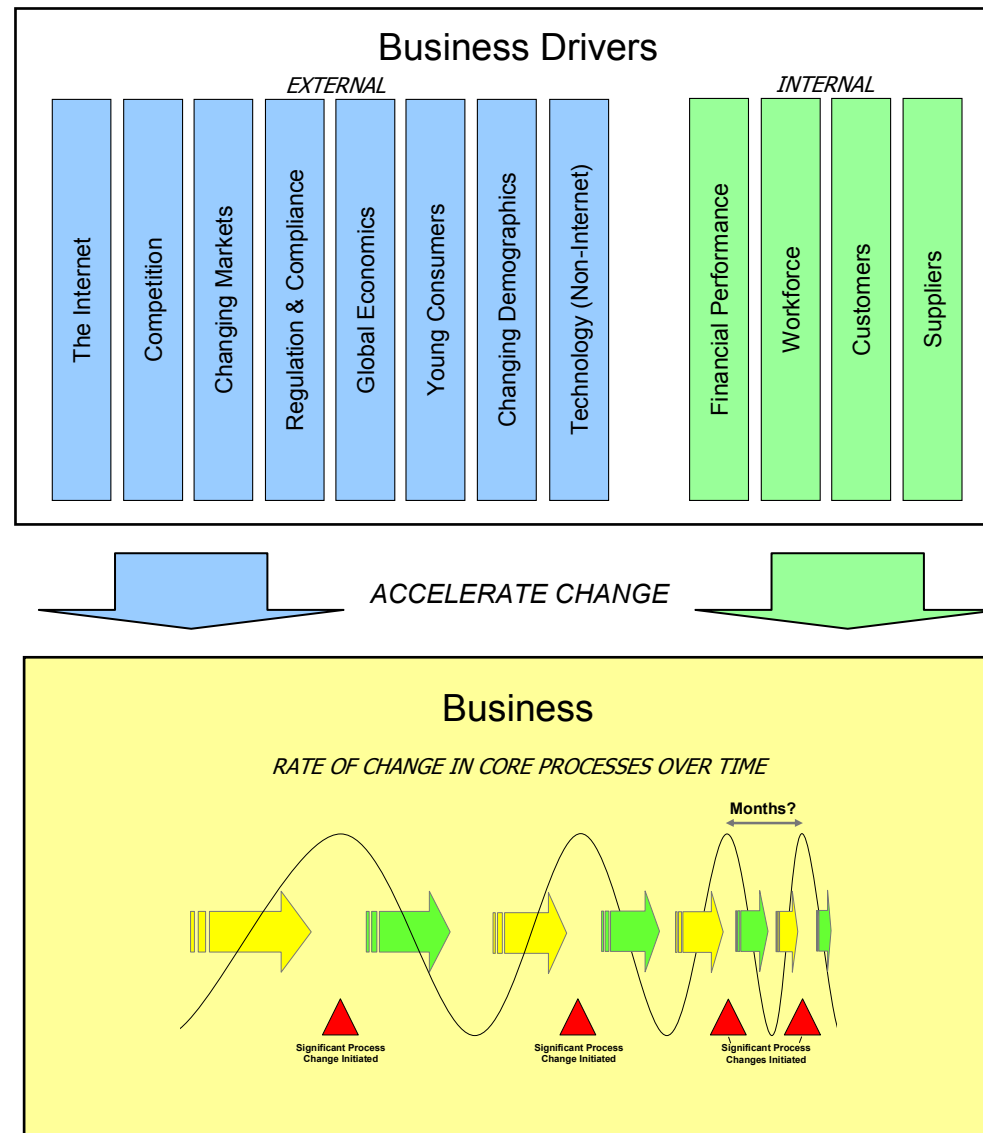
- **Our perspective: EA must be driven by the overarching business strategy of the 'Enterprise'**
 - Reflective of the desired operating model*
 - Take a holistic view
 - Identifying and enabling requirements for business capabilities that are enterprise-wide in scope (often not clearly articulated by the business)
 - Make decisions that are optimal for the enterprise not a specific project or LOB

- **Consequently, EA efforts must emphasize an 'E'-view**
 - The scope of EA is THE ENTERPRISE
 - “Solidify the Abstract” and “Simplify the Complex”
 - Gaining stakeholder support
 - EA team structure and participants
 - Governance
 - Communication

- **EA must demonstrate clear & unambiguous enterprise-wide linkages; and, as appropriate, explicit decomposition**
 - Enterprise Business Strategy to EA & Project Portfolio Management
 - Business Architecture to Information Architecture to Application Architecture to Technology Architecture

* Enterprise Architecture as Strategy: Creating a Foundation for Business Execution by Peter Weill, David C. Robertson and Jeanne W. Ross

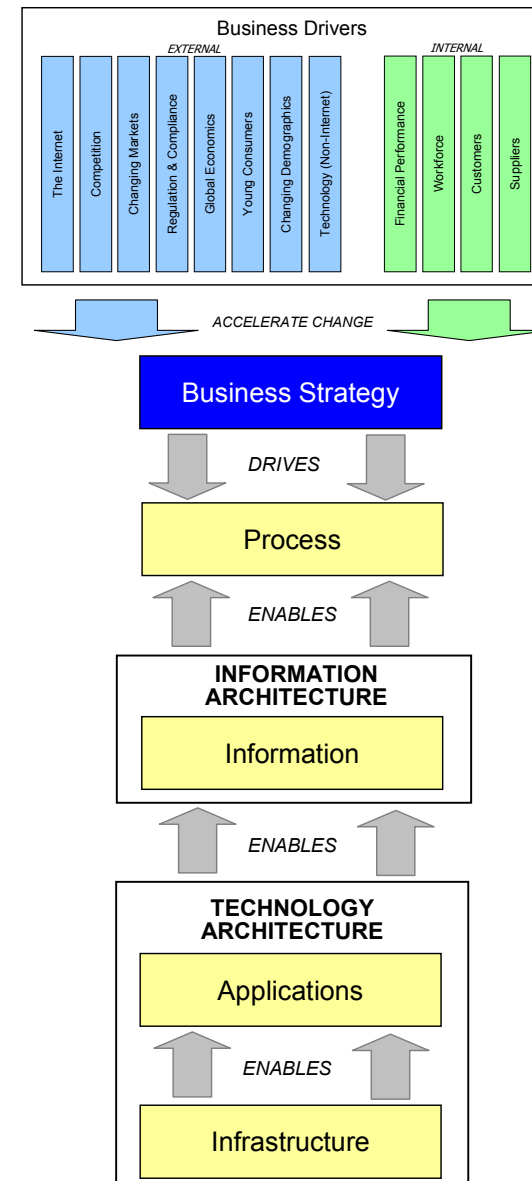
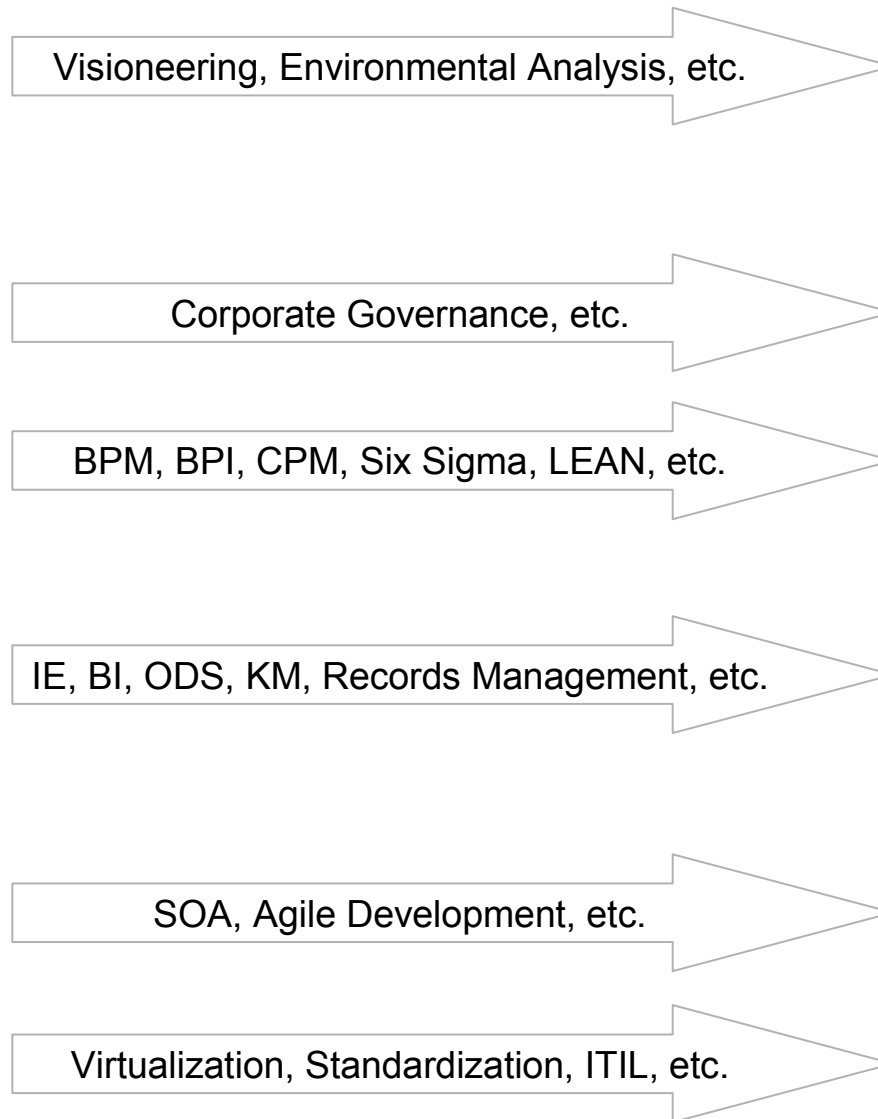
Business Drivers Require An Accelerated Rate of 'Change' in the Business to Remain Competitive



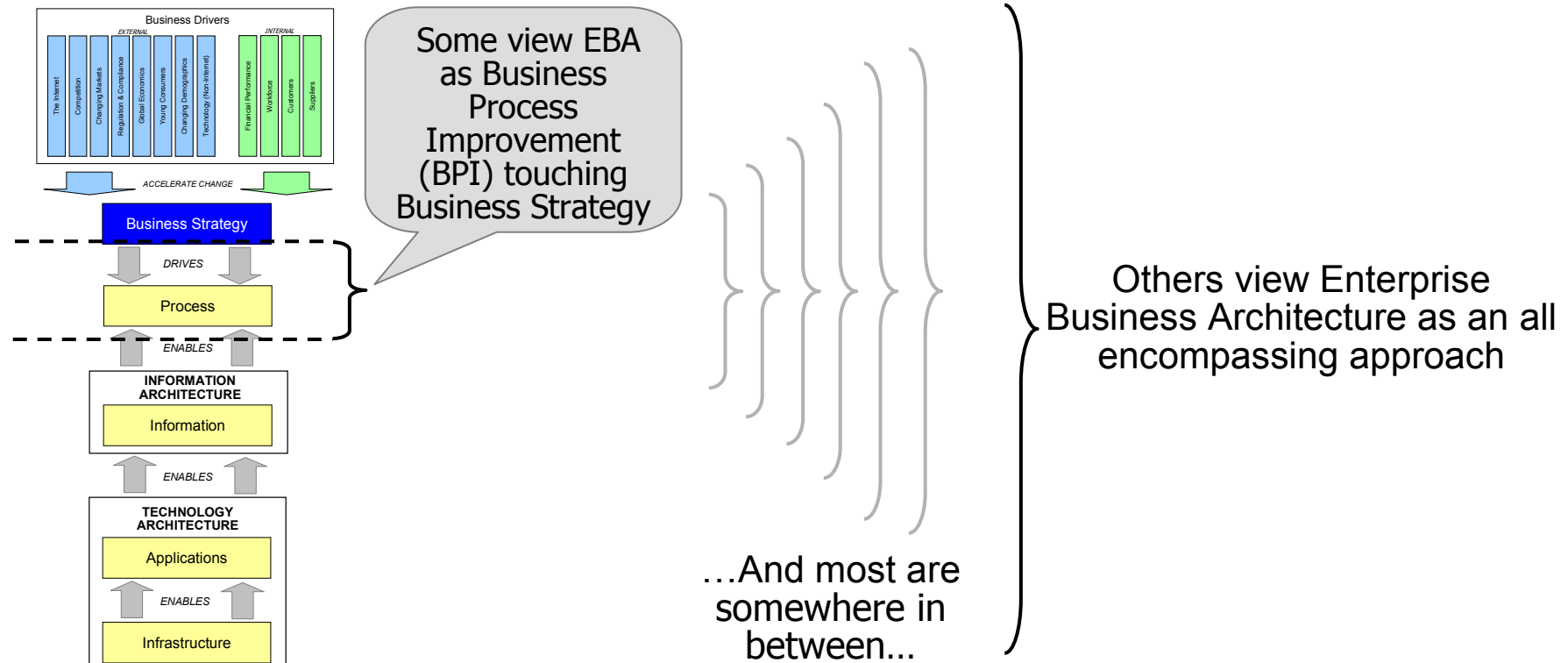
Businesses that fail to adapt to change as fast as their competition are 'at risk'

"So what do we do?"

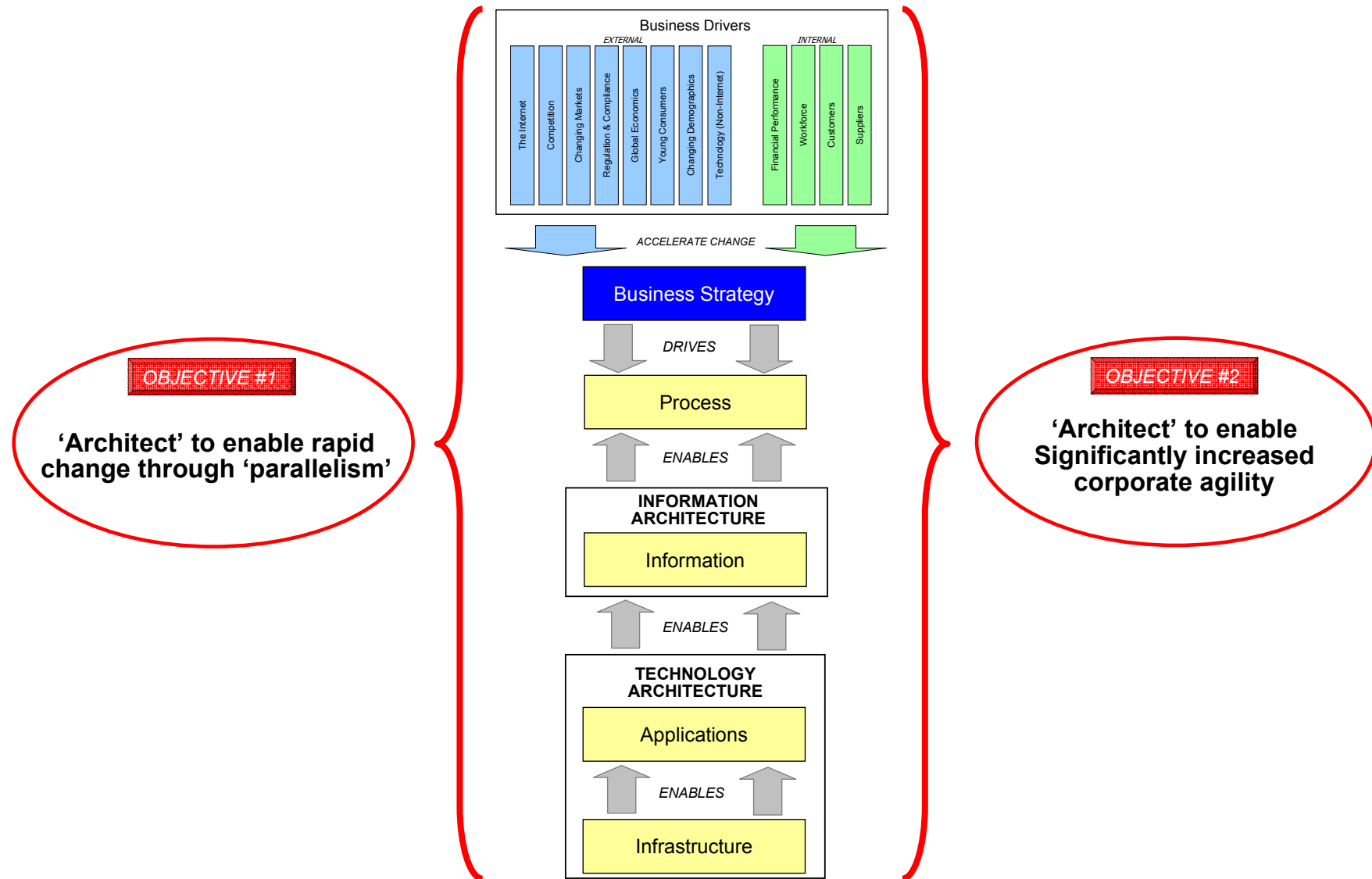
At Every Level There Are Efforts To Increase 'Agility' & Improve Performance



Enterprise Business Architecture (EBA) Is Emerging: Numerous Approaches/Limited Success

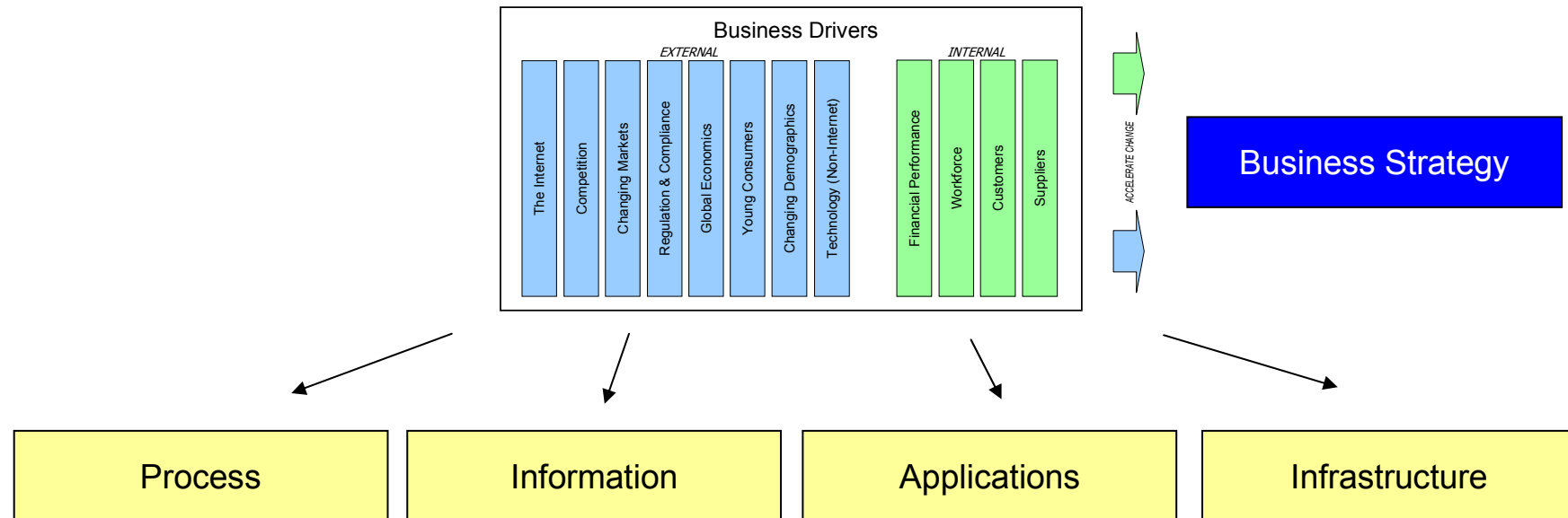


But None of These 'Solve' Our Need To...



We Need To 'Architect' Parallelism

Step 1: We Proactively Share Environmental Scans Across
The Breadth of the Management Team...



...and these must be accounted for in their long-term plans

How to Get There? - The Problem

- How can an enterprise establish a reasonable idea for all that has to happen in a complex organization to accommodate necessary change in support of business transformation?

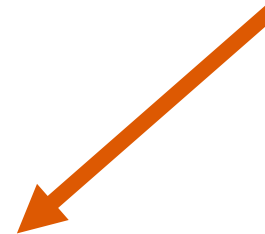


- **Capabilities are written to be understood by the business**
- **Capabilities suggest potential initiatives to be considered for project portfolio**
- **Capabilities are NOT current project-level requirements, but they should be compared to current and planned projects to incorporate/accommodate future needs in current implementations**
- **Capabilities should be revisited periodically (as new strategic plans are developed) and when major environmental trends or business factors indicate significant change (such as a merger/acquisition)**
- **Maintain linkages between trends, strategies and capabilities**
- **Use Capabilities to help give future-context to all planning activities**

- **Business Capability**
 - Reduce “opportunity to proposal” conversion time by 60%, from 10 to 4 business days
 - Use partner channels for targeted marketing campaigns to qualified prospects
- **Information Capability**
 - Sales/sales administration requires details of product/offering information in real time
 - Sales/sales administration requires details of all proposals and sales plans daily
- **Technology Capability**
 - Securely extend network to channel partners
 - Provide cross-enterprise workflow management capabilities
- **Solution Capability**
 - Coordinated, enterprisewide proposal generation to be utilized by product planning, customer fulfillment, sales, development, and consulting
 - Enterprisewide campaign management that coordinates development, customer delivery, marketing, sales, and resource management activities

Creating Linkage

	Trend A	Trend B	Trend C	Trend D
EBS 1	X	X		
EBS 2		X		
EBS 3				X



	BCC 1	BCC 2	BCC 3	BCC 4	BCC 5	BCC 6	BCC 7	BCC 8	BCC 9
ICC 1							X		
ICC 2	X	X	X					X	X
ICC 3		X			X		X		X
ICC 4	X		X						
ICC 5				X			X	X	
ICC 6		X					X		X
ICC 7			X			X			X

	EBS 1	EBS 2	EBS 3
BCC 1	X		
BCC 2		X	X
BCC 3	X	X	
BCC 4			X
BCC 5	X		
BCC 6	X	X	
BCC 7		X	
BCC 8	X		
BCC 9			X



	ICC 1	ICC 2	...	ICC N
TCC 1	X			
TCC 2		X		X
TCC 3	X	X		
.				X
.	X			
.	X	X		
TCC n		X		

7 'Best Practices' – Business/IT Alignment



- **Alignment artifacts are effective with the target audience**
- **Best artifacts are clear & 'stand alone'**
 - i.e. don't require a 'story teller'
- **Best artifacts have a high 'pass along' quotient**
- **Best artifacts are a single page**
- **Best artifacts emphasize metrics that are important to the business**
- **Get external review of your draft artifacts**
- **Always touch on 'tactical' & 'strategic'**
 - It is only an issue of degree

Our goal is to accelerate the effectiveness of communicating EA and demonstrating EA's value to non-technical Leadership.

We accomplish this by providing an approach and templates which can 'jump-start' those efforts and is framework agnostic.

UMCEA is not meant to be a substitute for other frameworks nor is it meant to gloss over the underlying detailed effort required to be successful.

Why Develop a Unified Model for Communicating EA?

Communicating EA's Value

Primary Audience
Is Non-Technical
Leadership &
Management

Leadership

Frameworks do not provide guidance
on communicating and demonstrating
the value of EA in a way that is
understood and embraced by non-
technical Leadership

EA Frameworks

Primary Audience
IS Technical
Staff

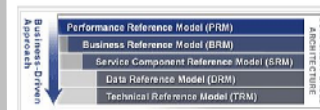
TOGAF



ZACHMAN



FEA



Others...

DODAF/MODAF
NASCIO
TAFIM
C4ISR
E2AF
GSRM
OCCA
CIMOSA
Open Blueprint
JTA
?

Corporate Leadership

- “How do I know if IT is doing the right things?”
- “How do all these different IT documents and efforts fit together?”
- “What IT deliverables are most important for me to understand?”

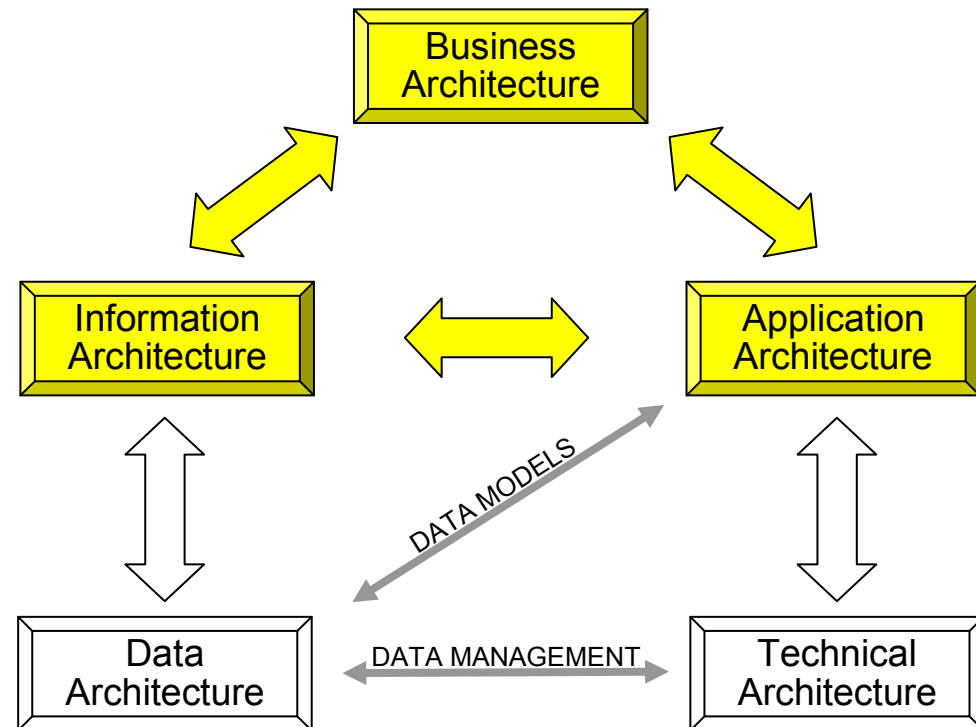
CIO & IT Leadership

- “How do we enable the business strategy?”
- “How can we effectively demonstrate that IT is doing the right things?”
- “How should all these different IT documents and efforts fit together?”

Enterprise Architecture

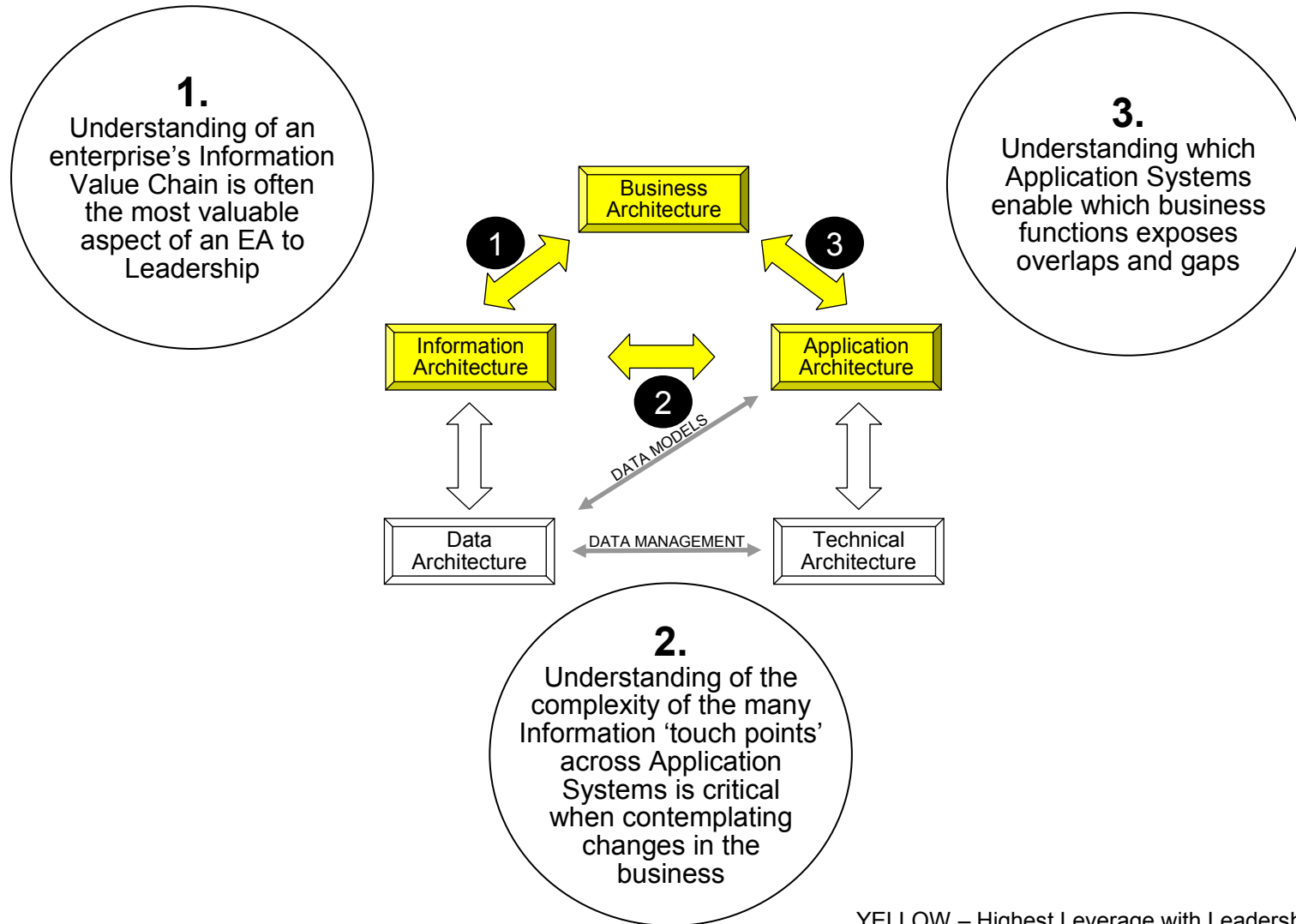
- “How do we produce EA artifacts that are easily understood by non-technical Leadership and Management (L&M)?”
 - Because EA artifacts appear too complex to be easily understood – few executives attempt to try
- “How do we abstract complex artifacts into simpler artifacts that are effectively consumable by L&M?”
 - In response to the above point
 - There is no meaningful literature
- “How should EA artifacts ‘directly map’ from one to the other?”
 - At best EA artifacts ‘point’ or ‘align’
 - There is no meaningful literature

- Each Model fits on a single page at the highest level of abstraction
- Arrows show where a Model is fully mapped with another Model(s)
- It is the 'mapping' from one Model to another that has the greatest value
 - Models in Yellow have the highest leverage with non-technical Leadership & Management (L&M)
- Organization structure should be easily mapped to:
 - Business Architecture
 - Information Architecture
 - Application Architecture



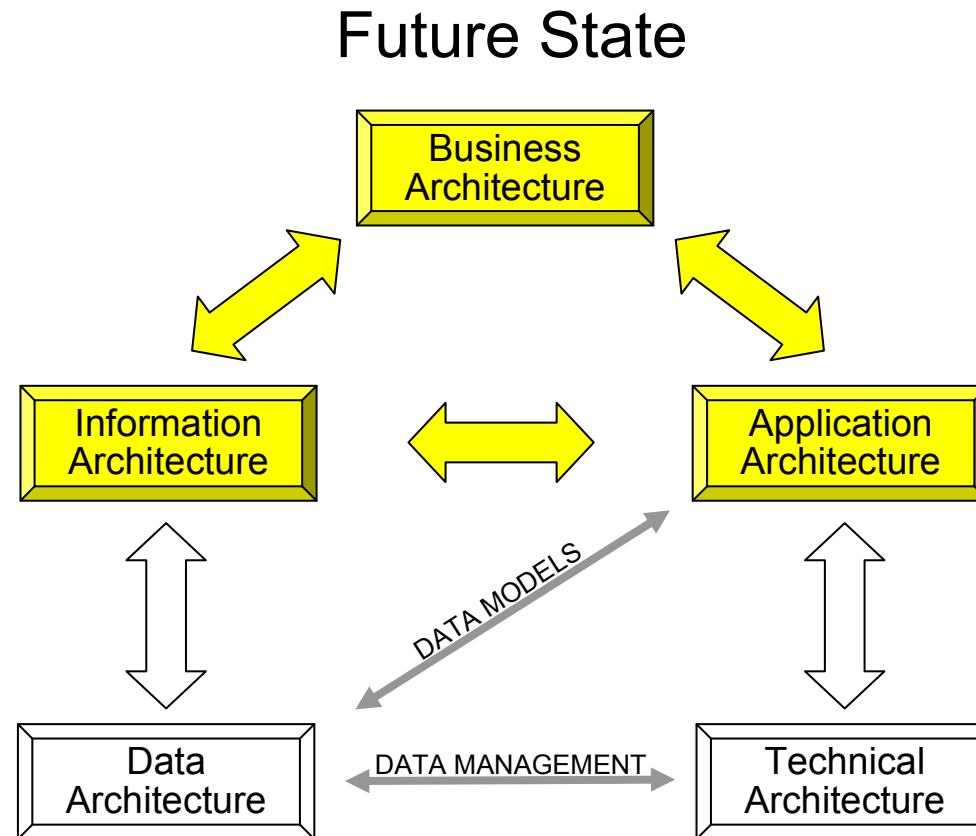
YELLOW – Highest Leverage with Leadership

Focus Leadership on the 'Golden Triangle'



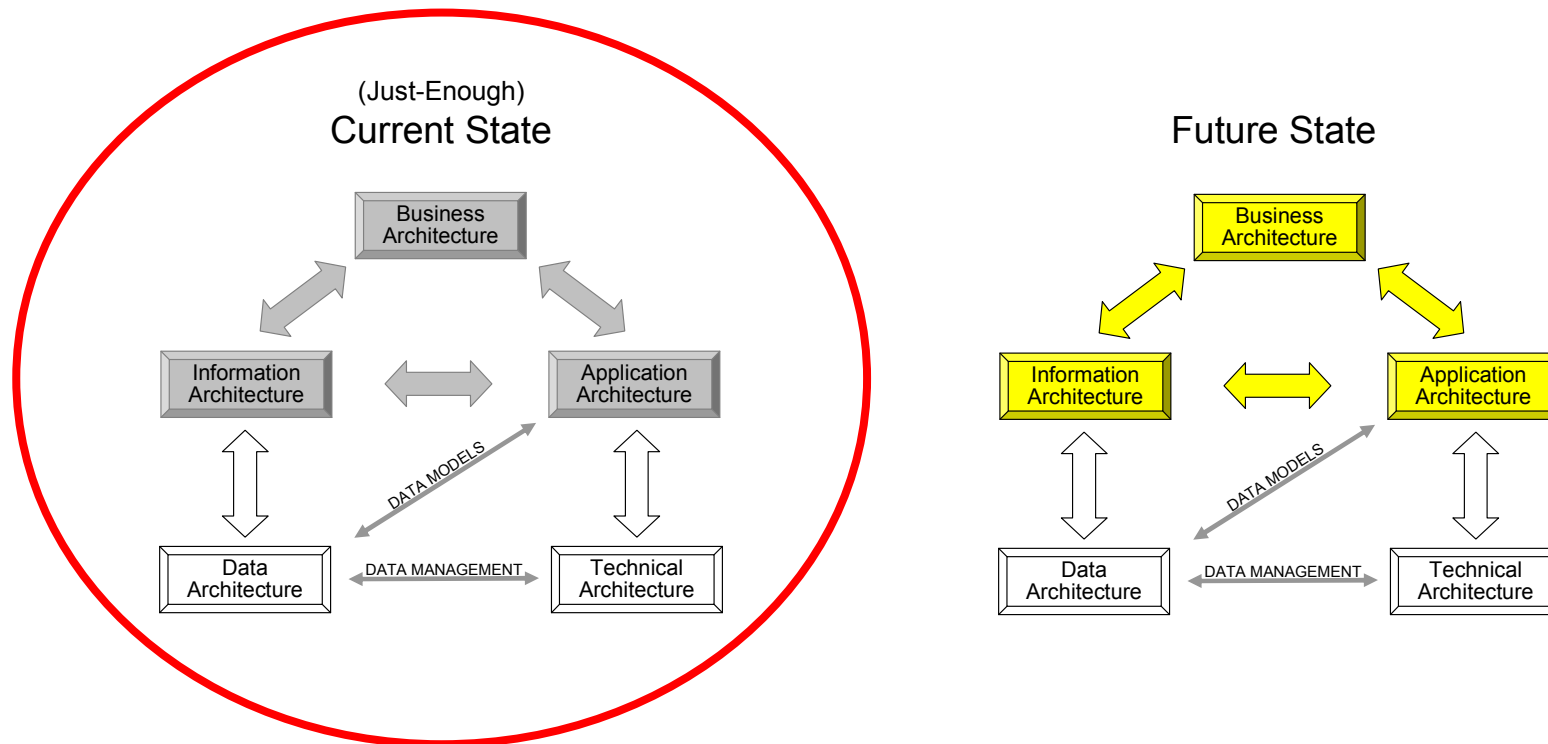
YELLOW – Highest Leverage with Leadership

An Overview of the Unified Model



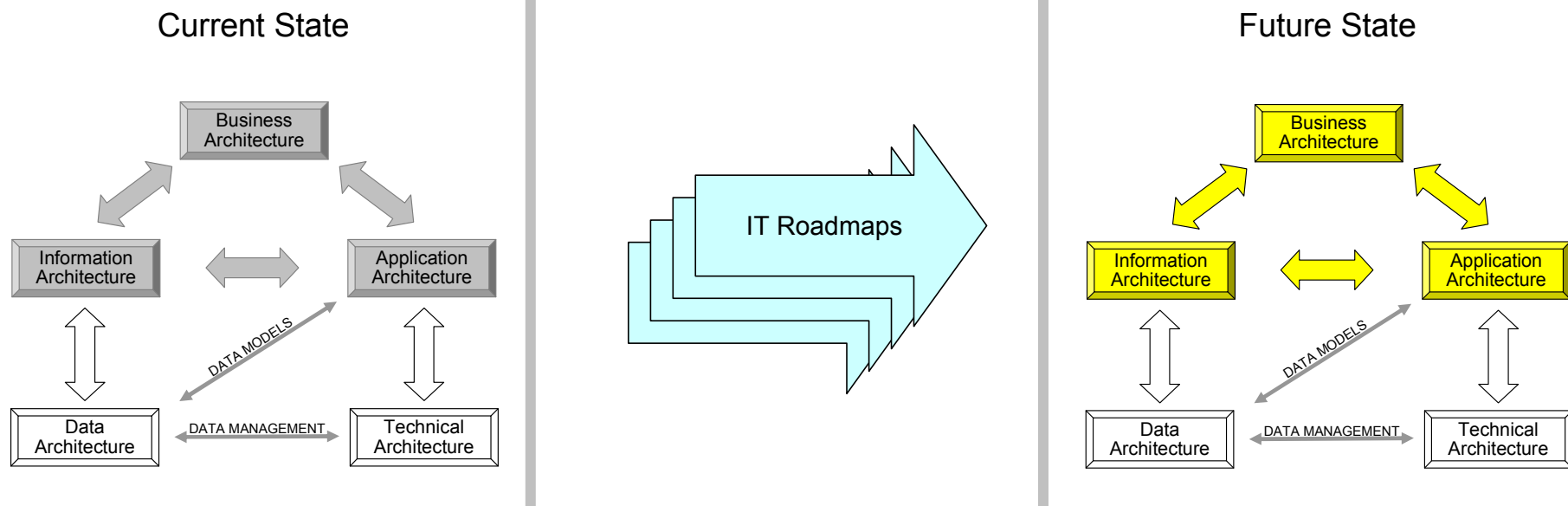
“How to we best enable the strategic objectives of the organization?”

We Then Capture (Just-Enough) 'Current State'

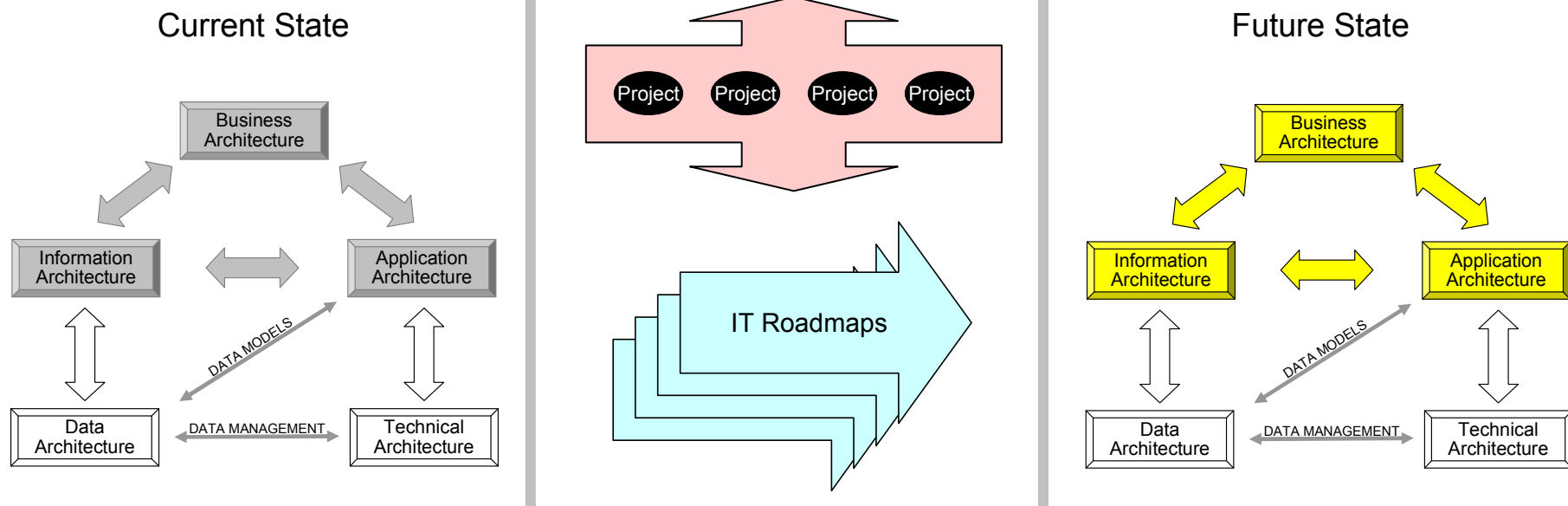


Capture 'just-enough' information about Current State as necessary to enable effective migration, address business requirements, and fully understand resource requirements. (At times, Current State may be the appropriate starting point for a variety of reasons.)

...and 'Roadmaps' to Achieve Transformation

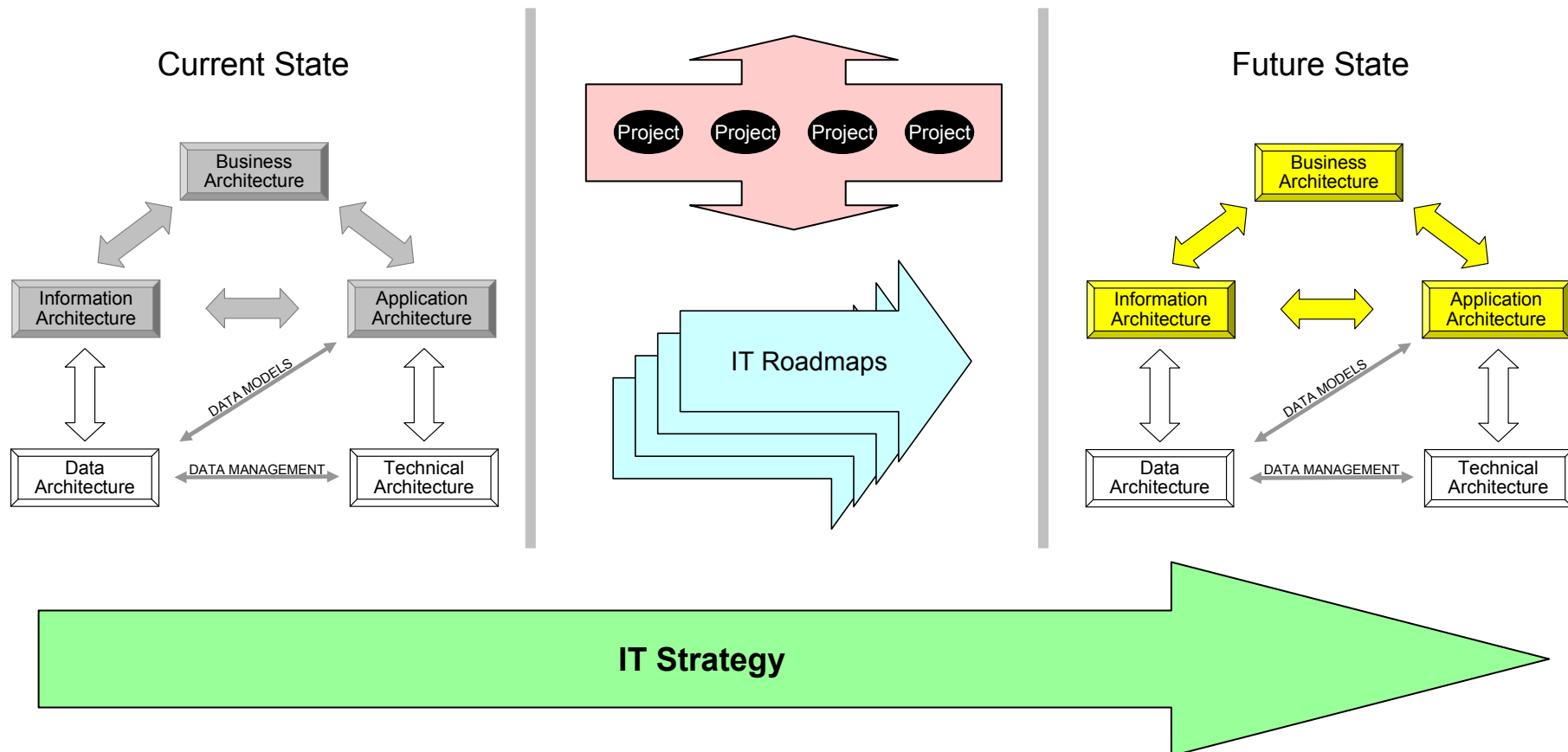


The 'Roadmaps' Generate Projects

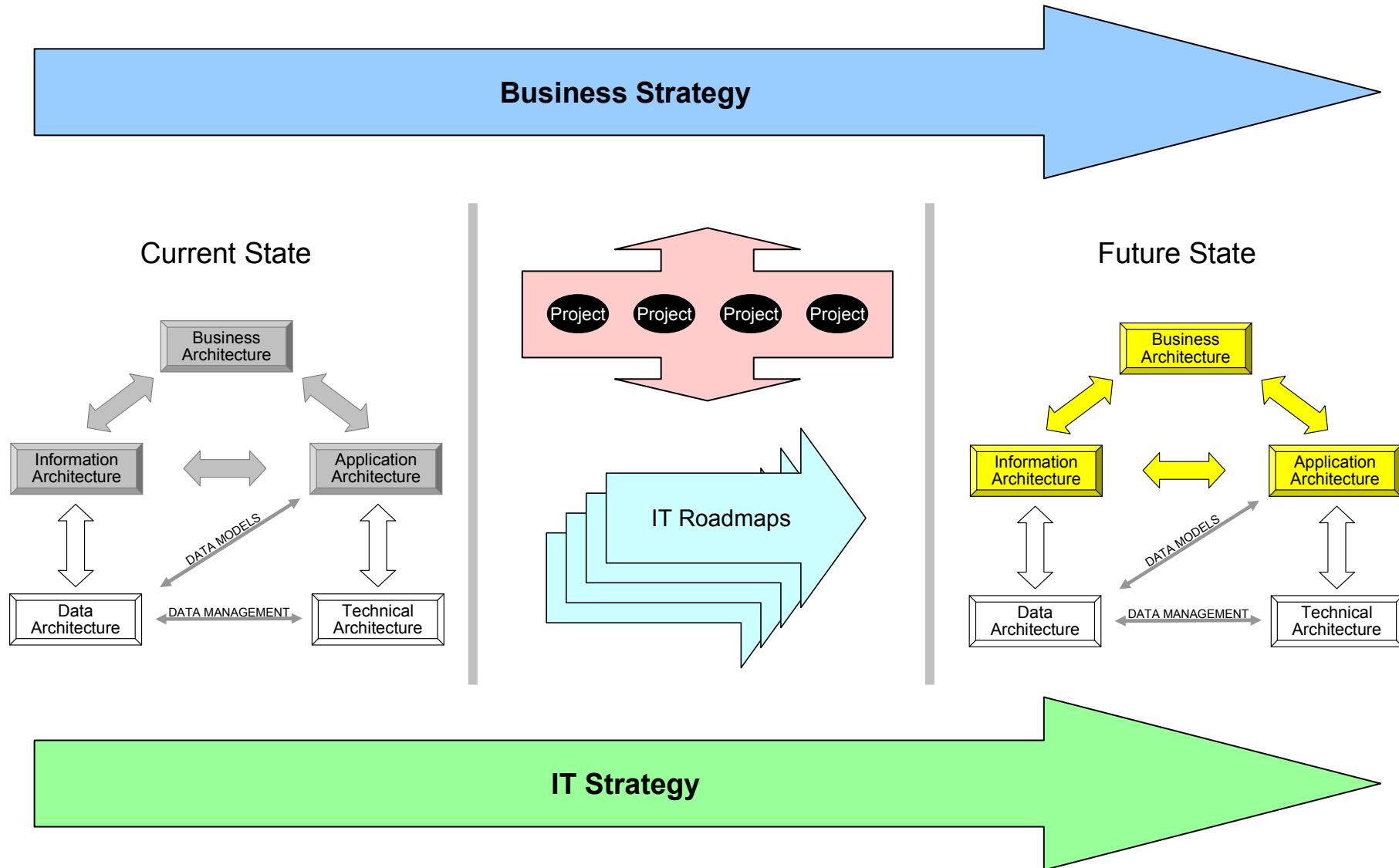


In Total – These Constitute Much of an IT Strategy

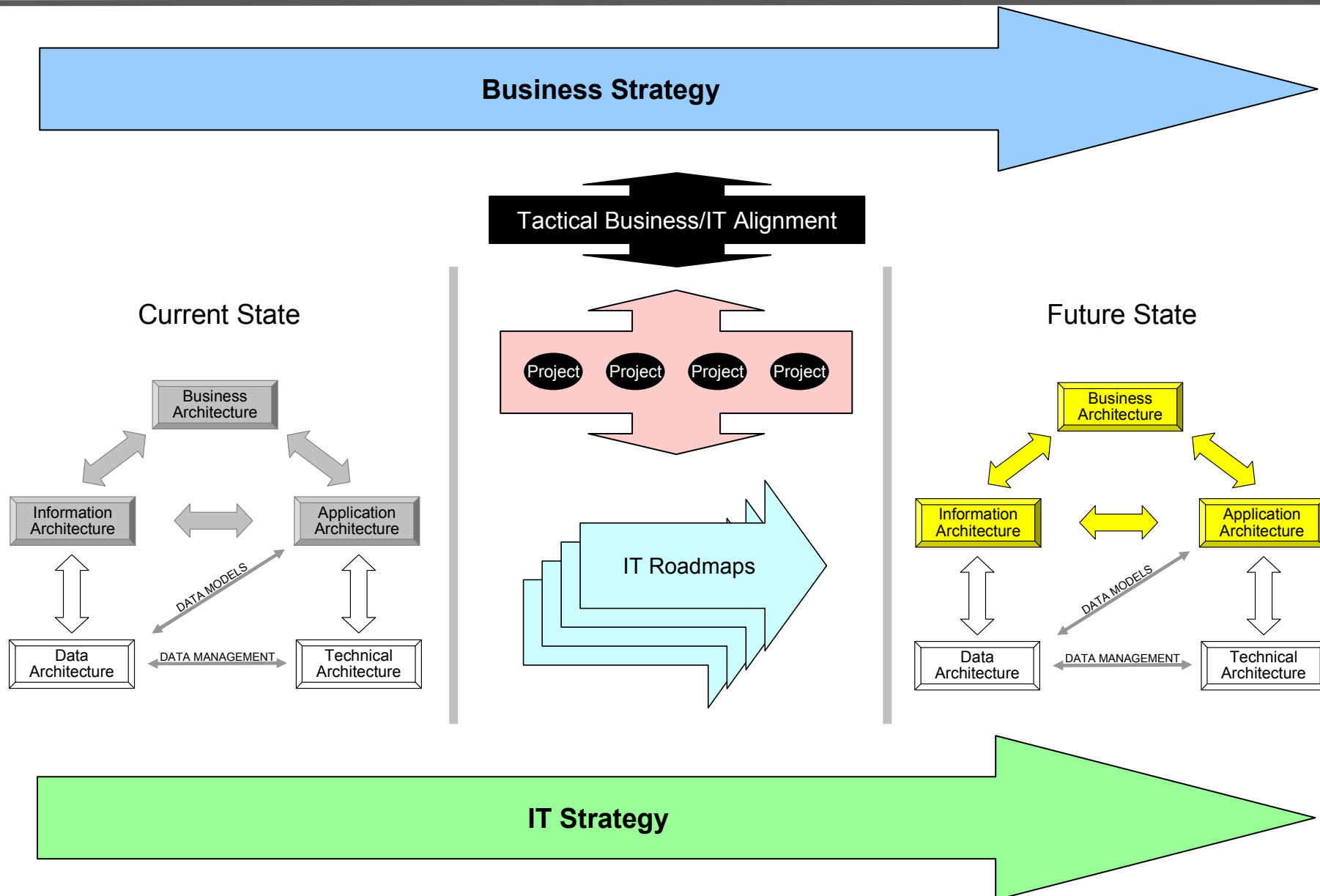
...when combined with resources, etc.



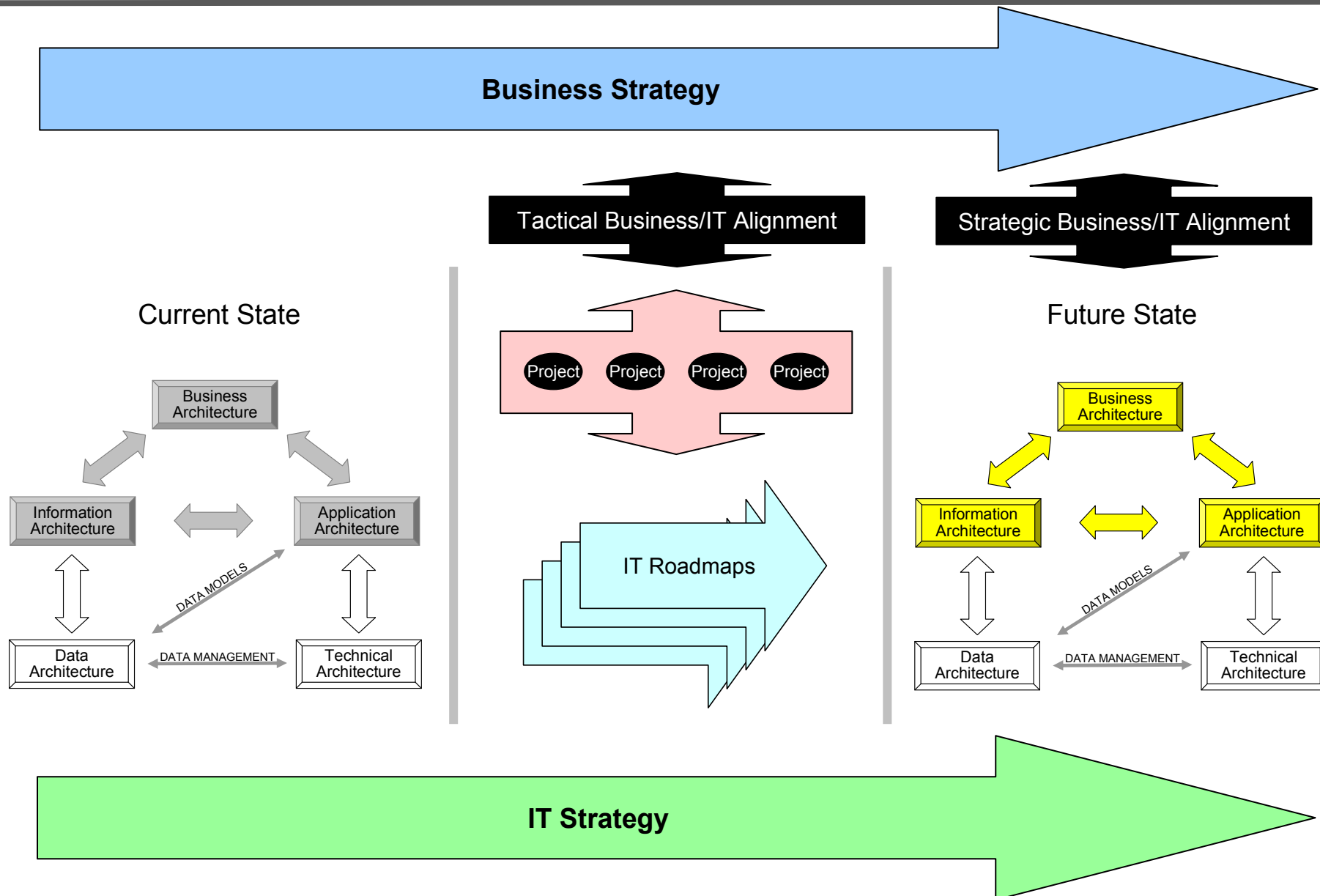
In Total, These Should Enable Business Strategy



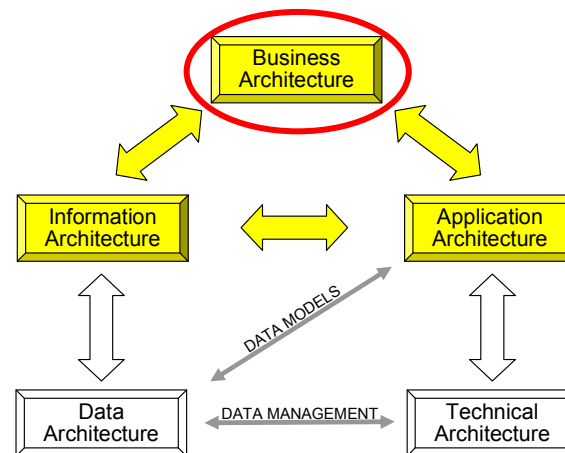
UMCEA Also Demonstrates Tactical Alignment...



...as Well as Strategic Business/IT Alignment



High-Level Approach to Communicating Business Architecture



Use a Simple Functional Hierarchy for EBA

- The diagram below represents the first two levels of a Functional Hierarchy (FH)
- This is a very effective starting EA point for non-technical executive

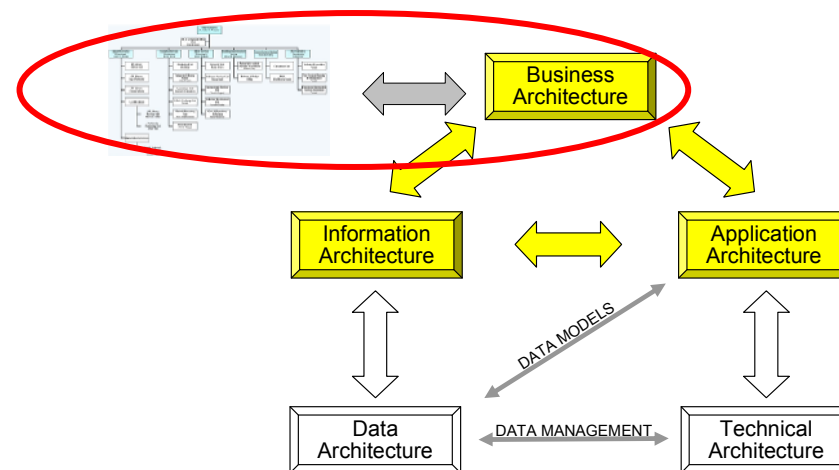
Company ABC

High Level Functional Hierarchy

1.0 Marketing			2.0 Sales			3.0 Engineering			4.0 Operations				5.0 Finance & Administration					
1.1 Public Relations & Communications			2.1 Prospecting & Lead Management			3.1 Research & Development			4.1 Procurement				5.1 Purchasing					
1.2 Advertising & Brand Management			2.2 Qualification			3.2 Product Development & Design			4.2 Manufacturing				5.2 Accounts Receivable					
1.3 Marketing Ops & Lead Generation			2.3 Sales Proposals			3.3 Product Engineering			4.3 Inventory				5.3 Accounts Payable					
			2.4 Sales Negotiations & Contracts						4.4 Shipping				5.4 Financial Reporting					
									4.5 Customer Service				5.5 Internal Audit					
									4.6 Returns				5.6 Human Resources					
													5.7 Information Systems (IT)					
													5.8 Legal					

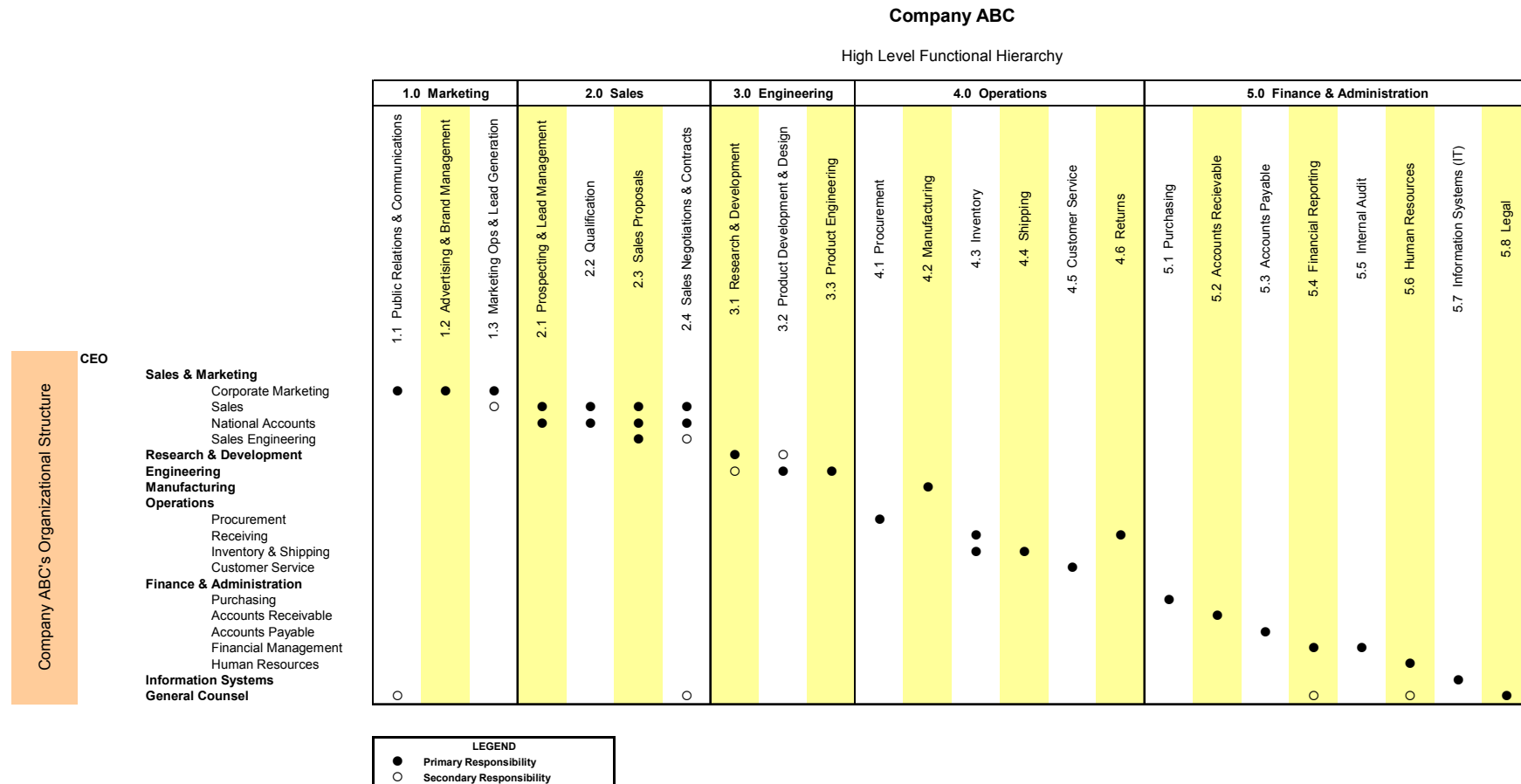
- The challenge with initially creating a Functional Hierarchy is that management and staff often try and make the FH reflect the organizational structure
 - Key is to make sure that a function is only identified once

Mapping Organizational Structure to Business Architecture

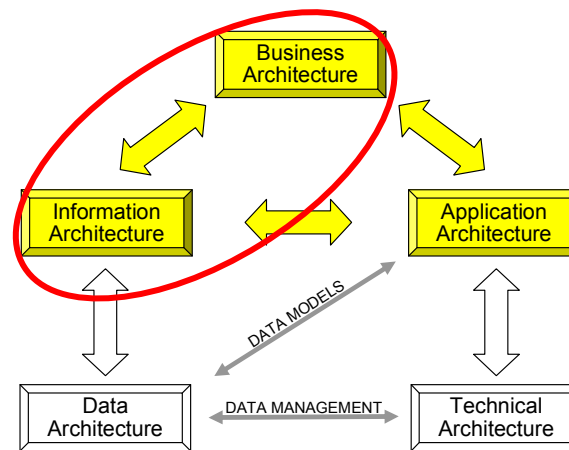


Mapping Organizational Structure to the BA/FH

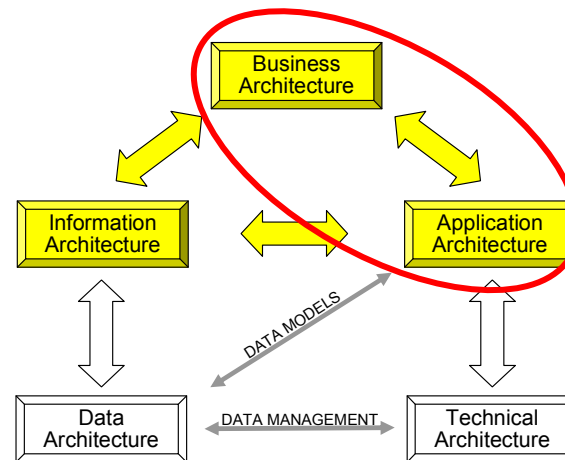
- Most Leadership starts by thinking about organizational structure – mapping organizational structure to the BA/FH helps them quickly grasp the distinction
- Mapping the organizational structure to the BA/FH is also useful for validating the completeness of the Functional Hierarchy



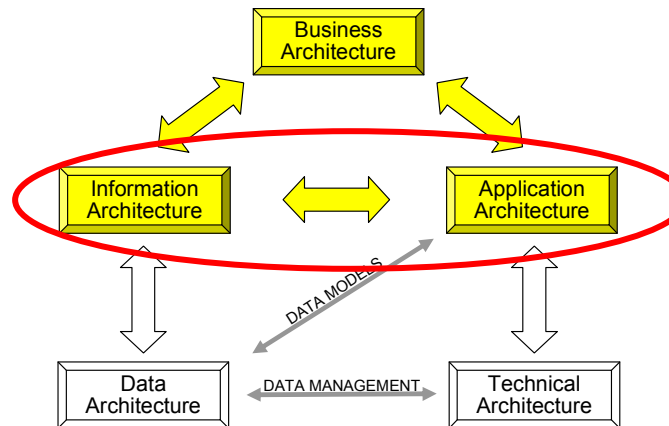
High-Level Approach to Communicating Information Architecture by Mapping to BA/FH



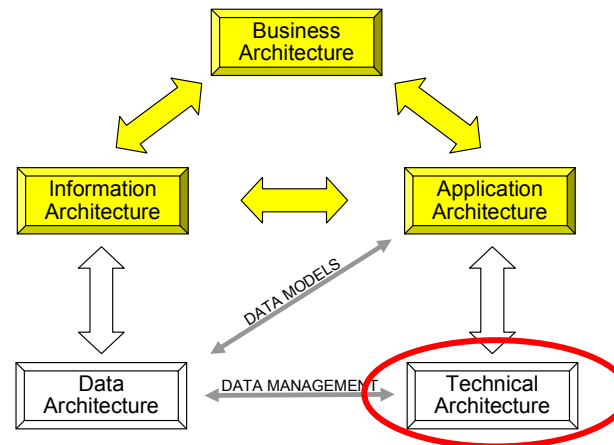
High-Level Approach to Communicating Application Architecture by Mapping to BA/FH



High-Level Approach to Mapping Information Arch. to Application Arch.



High-Level Approach to Communicating Technical Architecture



Technical Architecture (not fully populated)

- In the template below, a simple TA Reference Model is outlined on the vertical axis
- Products are entered into the matrix to complete the TA and categorized as 'Approved', 'Conditional' 'Retired', 'Prohibited' or 'Research'*
- Specific definitions of each category is provided under the category title; Products are also color coded depending on their categorization

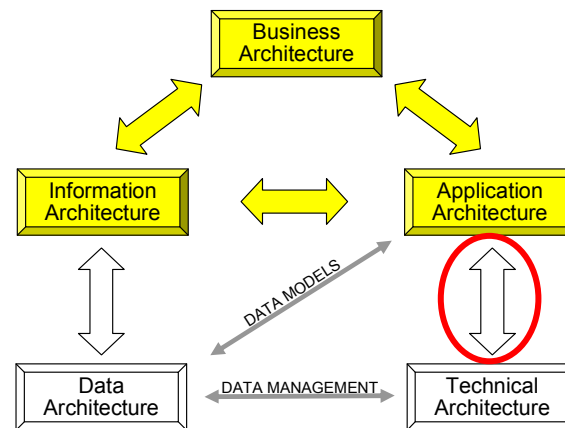
Company ABC
High Level Technical Architecture Reference Model

	Approved Products	Conditional Products	Retired Products	Prohibited Products	Research Products
Presentation Services Browser Portal Server Terminal Emulation Thin Client Services Other	IE 7.0 BEA AquaLogic Attachmate Extra Citrix		IE 6.0 VRG Reflection	Netscape	Firefox
Application Services Web Server Application Server Business Process Management Business Rules Email Content Management Collaboration Services Imaging Other	Microsoft IIS BEA WebLogic Microsoft Outlook Oracle Stellent Microsoft SharePoint	IBM CICS	Sun Java Web Server Lotus Domino	Apache Web Server Lotus Notes	
Development Environment Package Integrated Development Environment (IDE) Modeling & Design Tools Language Software Configuration Tools Testing Tools Service Integration Service Discovery Service Repository Other					
Integration Services Enterprise Application Integration (EAI) Data Integration (ETL) Transaction Data Management (TDM) Middleware Other	GoldenGate	Collingage ETL			
DBMS & File Management Relational DBMS Non-Relational DBMS File System Other	Oracle DB2 VSAM	MS SQL Server	Sybase MS	IBM, Access	
BI/Data Warehouse/Reporting Tools OLAP Software Analytics Tools Reporting Other	Hyperion, Cognos Business Objects, Crystal Other	SAS	MicroStrategy	SPSS	
Server Platforms Server Hardware Server Operating System Other	IBM x360 series Microsoft Windows Server Other	HP BladeView HP BladeView	HP 3000 HP BladeView	Sun SPARC	Real Time LINUX for Intel
Storage Storage Area Network (SAN) Backup/Archive File Services Other	SBC Data Protect StorageTek (Tape) SAS				
Network Network Devices Network Services Video Conferencing Name Resolution Services Remote Access Gateways Other	SDCC Cisco DMC, EDRCP			MS WINS	
Systems Management Operations Management Server Management Network Management Database Management Virtualization Capacity Planning Desktop Processing Other	Chen HCS SBC DB2, Oracle, Sybase Manager Virtuoso		HP OpenView		IBM Novell Zennaro
Security Corporate Firewall Server PKI Proxy Server Content Filter Server Anti-Virus Other	Red Hat IP MS Certificate Authority Microsoft Proxy Server Microsoft Internet Security Microsoft Internet Security Microsoft Internet Security		MS ISA Proxy Server		
Directory Internal Directories External Directories Directory Integration Other					
PCs Desktop Hardware Desktop Operating Systems Laptop Hardware Laptop Operating Systems PC Office Suite PC Email Client PC Firewall PC Antivirus PC Database	HP MS Office Symantec AV MS Access		Dell		

	Approved Products	Conditional Products
	Product is preferred and fully supported.	Product must meet certain conditions to be used.
Presentation Services Browser Portal Server Terminal Emulation Thin Client Services Other	IE 7.0 BEA AquaLogic Attachmate Extra Citrix	
Application Services Web Server Application Server Business Process Management Business Rules Email Content Management Collaboration Services Imaging	Microsoft IIS BEA WebLogic Microsoft Outlook Oracle Stellent Microsoft SharePoint	IBM CICS

* Research Products are Products that are being formally evaluated or tested within the organization – the purpose in identifying and communicating 'Research Products' is to eliminate redundant investigations and broaden participation

High-Level Approach to Mapping Technical Arch. to Application Arch.



- **There is a natural ‘hierarchy’ of EA artifacts and their relationships that emerges when artifacts are viewed from an L&M perspective**
- **In the most effective IT organizations, EA is merging/aligning with IT Strategy & PMO function**
 - Transparent and relatively ‘boundary-less’
 - CEO and Leadership Team does not segregate IT activities - “it’s all IT...”
- **EA, when done effectively, is a manifestation of strategy, nothing more, nothing less**
- **The artifacts that CEOs embrace are not necessarily the ones that Enterprise Architects view as most important**
- **Enterprise Architects too often view producing separate EA artifacts as “enough” and do not take the time to ensure that different artifacts integrate with each other**
 - Business Architecture, Application Architecture, Technical Architecture, etc.
- **EA artifacts that are understood by L&M generally are strongly embraced**
 - But few EA teams know how to make artifacts comprehensible
- **EA artifacts that are fully aligned and consistent from one to the other, significantly increase L&M’s confidence in IT**
 - But few EA teams know how to make artifacts consistent and fully integrated

EA is a management competency that:



- **Is a vehicle to achieve strategic alignment**
- **Expresses all dimensions of the enterprise**
 - Holistic across strategy, tactics, assets, projects
 - Business, Information, Technology and Solutions views
- **Links Strategy to Projects through an Asset view**
- **Communicates the “enterprise” perspective**
 - Incorporating multiple audience views and time horizons
 - Changes the way the enterprise thinks, analyzes and decides
- **Is part of the Governance and Portfolio Management Ecosystem**
- **Is Prescriptive and Actionable through directives, principles and roadmaps**
- **Helps drive improvement in the relationship between the business and the IT organization**
- **Is the one place in the enterprise that represent the best interests of everyone**

1. There is no single approach to establishing an effective Enterprise Architecture (EA) program.
2. When done correctly, Enterprise Architecture is a manifestation of an organization's mission, and the strategy which enables that mission.
3. The true measure of the effectiveness of an Enterprise Architecture is the extent to which it changes day-to-day behavior and decision making.
4. Many EA efforts fail because they attempt to be all encompassing and drive for perfection.
5. Enterprise architecture is a 'process' not a 'project'. It must be on-going and organic.
6. Producing EA artifacts is not enough. Too many EA teams focus on producing frameworks, diagrams, domain architectures, etc. And when they are done they declare victory.

Thank-You! (www.EAdirections.com)



George S. Paras



Larry R. DeBoever



Tim Westbrook

- **Founded by Larry R. DeBoever, George S. Paras, Tim Westbrook**
 - 50+ years of combined leadership in Enterprise Architecture
 - Launched the Enterprise Architecture Strategies (EAS) service at the META Group in 1996
 - Launched the EAC with in 1997, now produced by IIR
- **Core offerings:**
 - Coaching & Teaming Relationship: 12 month EA advisory service with dedicated mentor
 - Rapid EA Assessments, Education, Briefings, Workshops and Conferences
- **Our Mission - Improve the effectiveness of enterprise architecture (EA) teams by creating deep, mentoring relationships driven by independent research.**

Thought Leaders. Mentors. Deep Relationships.